



IDS11072

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Wednesday 16 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Friday 18 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A strong high pressure system south of the state will maintain a ridge across SA for the next few days as it drifts eastwards. A cold front is likely to approach from the west late Saturday and move across SA on Sunday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: East to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Sunny.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: East to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then tending east to northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, decreasing to 2 metres later in the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northerly during the morning then turning east to northeasterly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Sunny.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Easterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds tending northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning then tending north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the evening. Weather: Sunny.

Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning easterly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning northeasterly in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots inshore early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending easterly before dawn then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots south of Beachport early in the morning. Winds becoming variable below 10 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming west to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day then tending north to northwesterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre around midday, then increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Easterly 15 to 20 knots tending northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending northeast to southeasterly in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Sunny.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres around midday. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Wednesday 16 September until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 17 September

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to northeasterly below 10 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 18 September

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Sunny.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Wednesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.